

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 7 3
♥ K 6 4 3
♦ K 7 3 2
♣ 5 2

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 7 2

♦ A J 8

♣ K J 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 5

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ 9 6 4

♣ 10 3

♠ 9 6 2

♥ Q 5

♦ Q 10 5

♣ A Q 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Or not.

Remember: don't hold up when it gives the defenders a good opportunity to switch.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥J. You try dummy's ♥Q but West plays the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=5 Total = 7

Things do not look good. You have only one ♥ stopper, the ♠ suit is wide open, and you have to have the ♦ finesse to get the two extra winners you need.

First problem: Do you hold up the ♥A or not?

No, don't hold up. If you do they might take 4 ♠ tricks immediately, then go back to ♥s. Since your only hope of making this contract is the ♦ finesse you should grab the ♥A, play 5 rounds of ♣s then finesse for the ♦K.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 4
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ K J 10 3
 ♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ J 10 8 2
 ♥ Q 10 4
 ♦ 9 7
 ♣ A 10 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5
 ♥ A 7 2
 ♦ A Q 6 5
 ♣ K J 6

♠ 9 6 3
 ♥ K J 9 6 3
 ♦ 8 4 2
 ♣ Q 9

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when North plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

This is not a guess. If South has the ♣A he will get the lead and when he does he will set you with 2 more ♥ tricks. So you assume that North has the ♣A and play your ♣K.

This is a lesson about holding up, and if you had not held up twice in ♥s you would certainly have gone down.

But it's not enough to just be smart enough to hold up, you must also be able to figure out how to make the best plays later as well.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥6. North plays the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=0 Total = 8

Needing only one more winner you decide to hold up on the first ♥ and also the ♥ continuation. You take your ♥A on the third round, South having used the ♥3 to drive out your ♥A.

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when North plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

[showcards N:S7,C7,C5,C4 S:SK,CK,CJ,C6]

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦